

Product Requirements Document

1. Product Overview

Working Product Name: To be decided

Product Type: Responsive educational and spiritual web platform

Primary Market: India

Initial Languages: English and Hindi

Future Platform Expansion: Android and iOS applications

Product Vision

Create one of the most trusted, accessible, and beginner-friendly digital platforms for understanding Sanatan Dharma.

The platform should help users learn about Sanatan Dharma through authentic sources, structured explanations, scriptures, philosophy, traditions, practices, festivals, mantras, and AI-assisted learning.

The long-term objective is to make reliable knowledge about Sanatan Dharma easy to access while respecting its diversity of traditions and interpretations.

2. Problem Statement

Information about Sanatan Dharma is currently spread across books, websites, videos, social media, different traditions, and multiple languages.

A beginner may face several problems:

- They may not know where to start.
- Different websites may provide contradictory information.
- Religious information may be presented without sources.
- Complex Sanskrit or philosophical concepts can be difficult to understand.
- Users may not know whether something comes directly from scripture or from a later interpretation.
- Valuable knowledge is often scattered across many different websites and applications.
- Some content online may oversimplify or misrepresent traditions.
- Beginners may find traditional texts difficult to understand without explanations.

The proposed platform will organize reliable information into one structured and understandable learning environment.

3. Proposed Solution

Create a bilingual digital platform where users can:

- Learn Sanatan Dharma from beginner to advanced levels.
- Read and understand major scriptures.
- Explore major concepts and philosophies.
- Learn about deities and traditions.
- Read mantras and stotras.
- Understand major festivals.
- Search across religious content.
- Save important verses or pages.
- Ask questions through an AI learning assistant.
- View the sources used for important religious information.

The platform should combine traditional knowledge with a modern user experience.

4. Target Audience

Primary Audience

Indian teenagers and adults who want to understand Sanatan Dharma but may not know where to begin.

This includes:

- Students
- Young adults
- Beginners
- People interested in Indian philosophy
- Practicing Hindus wanting structured learning
- People trying to reconnect with Sanatan traditions

Secondary Audience

Future versions may also support:

- Children
- Parents
- Scholars
- Teachers
- International users
- Advanced practitioners
- Sanskrit learners

5. Product Principles

The platform should follow several core principles.

Accuracy Before Quantity

It is better to publish fewer high-quality, properly sourced pages than thousands of unreliable pages.

Source Transparency

Users should be able to understand where important religious information comes from.

Respect for Different Traditions

Sanatan Dharma contains many philosophical schools and traditions.

The platform should avoid presenting one interpretation as the only possible interpretation when respected traditions disagree.

Scripture vs Interpretation

The system should clearly distinguish between:

1. Original scripture
2. Translation
3. Traditional commentary
4. Modern explanation
5. AI-generated explanation

Beginner Friendly

Complicated ideas should be explained in understandable language without unnecessarily removing their philosophical depth.

Bilingual First

Hindi and English should both receive proper support.

Hindi should not simply feel like an automatically translated version of the English website.

Technology Supports Learning

AI should help users understand Sanatan Dharma.

It should not present itself as a guru, acharya, priest, or unquestionable spiritual authority.

6. Product Scope

The complete platform may eventually include:

Scriptures

- Bhagavad Gita
- Vedas
- Upanishads
- Ramayana
- Mahabharata
- Puranas
- Dharma literature
- Selected philosophical texts

Philosophy

- Dharma
- Karma
- Atman
- Brahman
- Moksha
- Samsara
- Maya
- Yoga
- Bhakti
- Jnana
- Karma Yoga
- Meditation
- Vedanta

Philosophical Schools

Future versions may explain traditions such as:

- Advaita Vedanta
- Vishishtadvaita
- Dvaita
- Samkhya
- Yoga
- Nyaya
- Vaisheshika

- Mimamsa
- Vedanta

Traditions

Possible sections may include:

- Vaishnavism
- Shaivism
- Shaktism
- Smarta tradition
- Other major traditions

Deities

Examples:

- Shiva
- Vishnu
- Krishna
- Rama
- Devi
- Ganesha
- Hanuman
- Saraswati
- Lakshmi
- Kartikeya

Spiritual Practices

- Puja
- Japa
- Meditation
- Yoga
- Bhakti
- Temple practices
- Pilgrimage
- Fasting
- Daily spiritual practices

Mantras and Stotras

- Sanskrit text
- Transliteration
- English meaning
- Hindi meaning
- Explanation

- Source
- Audio pronunciation in future versions

Festivals

Examples:

- Diwali
- Holi
- Janmashtami
- Maha Shivaratri
- Navratri
- Ram Navami
- Ganesh Chaturthi
- Makar Sankranti
- Raksha Bandhan
- Guru Purnima

Indian Knowledge

Possible future areas:

- Sanskrit
- Yoga
- Ayurveda
- Indian Knowledge Systems
- Ancient Indian philosophy
- Temple architecture
- Traditional calendars

7. Version 1 — MVP

The first version should remain focused.

It should not attempt to contain every scripture and every feature.

V1 Features

7.1 Homepage

The homepage should introduce the platform and help new users understand where to begin.

Possible sections:

- What is Sanatan Dharma?
 - Start Learning
 - Explore Bhagavad Gita
 - Popular concepts
 - Featured mantra
 - Upcoming festival
 - Ask the AI assistant
 - Continue learning
 - Recommended topics
-

7.2 Learn Sanatan Dharma

A structured learning path for beginners.

Example learning path:

Sanatan Dharma

↓

Dharma

↓

Karma

↓

Atman

↓

Brahman

↓

Samsara

↓

Moksha

↓

Yoga

↓

Bhakti

↓

Major philosophies

Users should be able to progress from simple concepts toward deeper material.

7.3 Bhagavad Gita

The Bhagavad Gita should be one of the flagship parts of the platform.

Users should be able to browse:

Chapter

↓

Verse

Each verse may contain:

- Chapter number
 - Verse number
 - Sanskrit text
 - Roman transliteration
 - Hindi translation
 - English translation
 - Word-by-word meaning
 - Simple explanation
 - Commentary
 - Source information
 - Related concepts
 - Bookmark button
-

8. Scripture Library

Version 1 should introduce the major categories of Sanatan scriptures.

Initial library may contain:

- Bhagavad Gita
- Vedas
- Upanishads
- Ramayana
- Mahabharata
- Puranas

Not every scripture needs to contain its complete text immediately.

Each scripture page can initially explain:

- What the scripture is
- Approximate structure
- Major themes
- Importance
- Important sections
- Related traditions
- Recommended learning path

The full text library can expand gradually.

9. Deities Section

Users should be able to learn about major deities.

Each page may contain:

- Introduction
- Sanskrit name
- Meaning of the name
- Important attributes
- Symbols
- Major stories
- Important scriptures
- Associated festivals
- Important mantras
- Philosophical significance
- Different traditional interpretations

- Related deities

The platform should avoid oversimplifying relationships between deities.

10. Mantras and Stotras

Users should be able to browse mantras and devotional texts.

Each mantra page may contain:

- Name
- Sanskrit
- Transliteration
- Pronunciation guide
- Hindi meaning
- English meaning
- Source
- Context
- Explanation
- Traditional usage

Future versions may include professional audio pronunciation.

11. Festivals

Each festival page should explain:

- Name
- Meaning
- Why it is celebrated
- Associated stories
- Relevant scriptures
- Major practices
- Regional variations
- Philosophical significance
- Frequently asked questions

The platform should acknowledge that festival practices may differ across regions.

12. Search

Users should be able to search across:

- Concepts
- Scriptures
- Verses
- Deities
- Mantras
- Festivals
- Articles

Example:

User searches:

karma

Results may include:

- Meaning of Karma
 - Bhagavad Gita verses about Karma
 - Karma Yoga
 - Related Upanishadic ideas
 - Frequently asked questions
-

13. AI Dharma Assistant

A major feature of the platform will be an AI learning assistant.

Working name:

Ask Dharma

Name to be decided later.

Users may ask questions such as:

- What is Dharma?
- What is the difference between Karma and Karma Yoga?
- Explain Bhagavad Gita 2.47.
- Who is Shiva?
- What is Moksha?
- What do the Upanishads say about Atman?

- Explain this verse simply.
 - Explain this in Hindi.
 - What should I learn after understanding Karma?
-

14. AI Answer Structure

Where appropriate, AI answers should follow a structure like:

Short Answer

Simple explanation.

Scriptural Basis

Relevant verses or texts.

Explanation

Beginner-friendly explanation.

Traditional Interpretations

Different interpretations where relevant.

Sources

References used to create the answer.

Explore Next

Related topics the user could learn.

15. AI Safety and Accuracy Requirements

The AI should:

- Prefer verified platform sources.
- Provide citations wherever possible.
- Clearly distinguish scripture from commentary.
- Avoid inventing verses.
- Avoid inventing Sanskrit quotations.
- Avoid presenting uncertain claims as facts.
- Mention when traditions interpret a subject differently.

- Avoid declaring one sect or tradition superior.
- Avoid claiming divine authority.
- Allow users to view the original source.

For sensitive theological questions, answers should acknowledge respected differences between traditions.

16. User Accounts

Version 1 should support user accounts.

Authentication options may eventually include:

- Email
- Google login
- Apple login

Exact authentication system will be decided in the technical requirements document.

Logged-in users should eventually be able to:

- Bookmark verses
 - Save articles
 - Save mantras
 - Select preferred language
 - Maintain reading history
 - Continue learning
 - Store learning progress
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17. Personalized Dashboard

A basic dashboard may eventually display:

Namaste, [User]

Continue Learning

Bhagavad Gita — Chapter 2

Saved Verses

Saved Mantras

Recommended Topic

Daily Shloka

Upcoming Festival

Learning Progress

The exact V1 dashboard scope will be determined during UI/UX planning.

18. Language Support

Version 1:

- English
- Hindi

Content should support:

Sanskrit

Original Devanagari scripture where available.

Transliteration

Romanized pronunciation.

English

Translation and explanation.

Hindi

Translation and explanation.

Example:

Sanskrit

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते...

Transliteration

karmany-evādhikāras te...

English

English translation.

हिन्दी

Hindi translation.

19. Navigation

Initial navigation concept:

Home

Learn

Scriptures

Bhagavad Gita

Deities

Mantras

Festivals

Ask AI

Search

My Library

Profile

The final navigation will be decided during information architecture planning.

20. Design Direction

Working visual direction:

Modern Indian Spiritual

The website should combine modern digital-product design with subtle Indian cultural influences.

The design should feel:

- Calm
- Trustworthy
- Respectful
- Modern
- Spiritual
- Premium
- Easy to read

Avoid making the website excessively decorative.

Possible design elements include:

- Traditional Indian patterns used subtly
- Sanskrit typography
- Devanagari typography
- Warm natural colours
- Saffron accents
- Gold accents
- Cream backgrounds
- Deep red or earthy colours
- Temple-inspired geometry
- Mandala patterns used sparingly
- High-quality illustrations

Exact colours and design system will be determined in the UI/UX specification.

21. Responsive Design

The website must work properly on:

- Desktop computers
- Laptops
- Tablets
- Mobile phones

Mobile usability should be considered from the beginning because a large percentage of Indian users may access the platform primarily through smartphones.

22. Accessibility

The platform should aim for:

- Readable typography
 - Appropriate contrast
 - Keyboard navigation
 - Screen-reader-friendly structure
 - Scalable text
 - Clear navigation
 - Hindi typography support
 - Mobile accessibility
-

23. Content Management

An administrative system will eventually be required.

Administrators should be able to:

- Add articles
- Edit articles
- Add scriptures
- Add verses
- Add translations
- Add commentaries
- Add festivals
- Add deities
- Add mantras
- Manage sources
- Review AI-related content
- Correct errors
- Manage users
- Manage homepage content

This will be defined fully in the technical document.

24. Source Management

Every important religious content record should ideally contain source information.

Example:

Scripture: Bhagavad Gita

Chapter: 2

Verse: 47

Translation source: [Source]

Commentary: [Commentator]

Language: English

Editor: [Editor]

Verification status: Verified

This will allow the platform to maintain transparency.

25. Content Verification

A content verification workflow should eventually exist.

Possible states:

Draft

↓

Under Review

↓

Verified

↓

Published

AI-generated religious information should not automatically become permanent website content without review.

26. Monetization

The core platform should remain free.

Potential future revenue sources may include:

- Voluntary donations
- Supporter memberships
- Optional premium tools
- Educational courses
- Books
- Special learning programs

Essential Sanatan Dharma learning material should preferably remain freely accessible.

No monetization system needs to be included in the first MVP unless required.

27. Community

Community functionality will NOT be included in Version 1.

Possible future community features include:

- Questions and answers
- Study groups
- Discussions
- Community learning
- Festival discussions

Community functionality would require strong moderation because religious discussions can involve misinformation, sectarian disagreements, spam, or inappropriate content.

28. Out of Scope for Version 1

The following should initially remain outside the MVP:

- Large public forums
- Social network
- User-generated religious articles
- Complete translations of every scripture
- Temple booking
- Priest booking

- Donation marketplace
- Astrology services
- Matrimonial features
- Full Panchang platform
- Live-streaming platform
- E-commerce marketplace
- Native Android application
- Native iOS application

These can be evaluated later.

29. Success Metrics

Early product success may be measured using:

- Monthly active users
- Returning users
- Pages read per session
- Learning-path completion
- Bhagavad Gita verses viewed
- AI questions asked
- AI answer satisfaction
- Search success rate
- Bookmarks created
- Average reading time
- Hindi vs English usage
- User retention

Specific target numbers will be decided after launch planning.

30. Major Risks

Religious Accuracy

Incorrect information could damage trust.

Mitigation: sourcing and verification system.

AI Hallucination

AI could generate incorrect verses or interpretations.

Mitigation: source-grounded retrieval and citations.

Sectarian Bias

The platform could unintentionally favour one tradition.

Mitigation: clearly identify interpretations and traditions.

Massive Scope

Sanatan Dharma contains enormous amounts of literature.

Mitigation: build gradually instead of trying to cover everything immediately.

Copyright

Modern translations or commentaries may be copyrighted.

Mitigation: verify licensing and use public-domain or properly licensed content.

Translation Quality

Poor Hindi or English translations could change meanings.

Mitigation: human review and trusted translations.

31. Future Possibilities

After the core platform succeeds, future versions may introduce:

- Native mobile applications
- Daily Panchang
- Temple discovery
- Pilgrimage guides
- Interactive maps
- Scripture audio
- Sanskrit pronunciation
- Advanced learning paths
- Quizzes
- Certificates
- AI voice assistant
- Personalized spiritual-learning plans
- Children's learning mode
- Scholar mode
- Comparative commentary viewer
- Timeline of texts and traditions
- Interactive family trees

- Festival notifications
 - Offline scripture reading
 - Downloadable learning material
-

32. MVP User Journey

Example beginner journey:

User searches:

"I want to understand Sanatan Dharma."

↓

Homepage

↓

Start Learning

↓

What is Sanatan Dharma?

↓

Learn Dharma

↓

Learn Karma

↓

Relevant Bhagavad Gita verses

↓

Ask AI a question

↓

Save useful verse



Create account



Continue learning later

This should be one of the central experiences of Version 1.

33. Product Positioning

The platform should not primarily position itself as:

"Another Hindu information website."

Instead, the desired positioning is:

A trusted digital learning platform for exploring Sanatan Dharma through authentic sources, structured learning and modern technology.

34. Current Open Decisions

The following decisions remain open:

- Final product name
- Logo
- Exact colour palette
- Exact typography
- Trusted scripture sources
- Preferred translations
- Preferred commentaries
- AI model/provider
- Technology stack
- Database technology
- Hosting provider
- Authentication provider
- Search engine
- Exact admin system
- Exact V1 feature priority
- Panchang inclusion
- Audio inclusion

- Donation system
- Premium features
- Mobile application timeline

These do not need to be decided before completing the current PRD.

They will be handled in later planning documents.

35. Recommended Product Development Order

The project should proceed in this order:

1. Product Requirements Document



2. Information Architecture



3. Content & Source Strategy



4. UI/UX Design Specification



5. Technical Requirements Document



6. Database Schema



7. AI Architecture



8. API Design



9. Development Plan



10. Coding



11. Testing



12. Deployment

This process will reduce unnecessary rewriting and architectural mistakes.